

Dear Costa Coffee Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Location Strategy Analyst role at Costa Coffee. I have five years of experience using spatial analysis for city planning decisions and an MSc in Urban Spatial Science from CASA UCL, where I completed an industry-sponsored dissertation on retail spending patterns. I believe my background will help support Costa's location intelligence and network planning goals.

For my dissertation, I worked with CACI Ltd through the GeoDS industry placement scheme to study how urban form predicts retail spending patterns across UK cities. I used CACI's consumer spending data, Python, GeoPandas, and spatial autocorrelation analysis to model economic behavior on a national scale. This research involved managing large, varied datasets, building repeatable analytical workflows, finding important spatial patterns in complex data, and sharing results clearly with non-technical audiences. Retail location intelligence is central to my research.

Before my MSc, I led urban design teams at Derman Verbakel Architecture in Tel Aviv for five years. There, I created geo-computational workflows in QGIS and ArcGIS for mapping, market analysis, and profitability modeling on fifteen projects for both municipal and private clients. I trained team members in GIS, prepared spatial data reports for planning committees, and managed client relationships from start to finish. I have seen firsthand how location decisions are made and how data can support or challenge them.

I have strong skills in QGIS and ArcGIS, and I am proficient in Python, including GeoPandas, pandas, and scikit-learn. I have experience explaining complex spatial analysis to both commercial and municipal audiences. I am comfortable managing datasets, ensuring data quality, and building workflows that enable repeatable, scalable analysis.

What interests me most about this role specifically is the interesting questions it raises: where do people go, why do they choose those places, and how does the market open up new opportunities? I enjoy using spatial data to predict human behavior and turn that knowledge into real location decisions. I would be excited to work with Costa's team and explore these problems at both the local and global levels.

Thank you for considering my application.

Warm regards,

Emily Deeb

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